

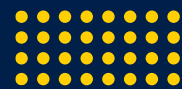
Research Methodology

Reference Styles and Visualization

Reference Management, Figure Quality and Tools

By:

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 www.begindiscovery.com

Reference Styles

- In research papers, **reference styles** define how you format citations and bibliographies. They ensure consistency and clarity in academic writing.

Reference Styles

- **APA (American Psychological Association)**
 - Common in: Social sciences, psychology, education.
 - **In-text citation:** (Author, Year)
 - **Example:** (Smith, 2023)
 - **Reference list:** Author, A. A. (Year). Title of work. Publisher.
- **MLA (Modern Language Association)**
 - Common in: Humanities, literature.
 - **In-text citation:** (Author Page)
 - **Example:** (Smith 45)
 - **Works Cited:** Author Last Name, First Name. *Title of Book*. Publisher, Year.
- **Chicago/Turabian**
 - Common in: History, arts.
 - Two systems:
 - **Notes and Bibliography:** Footnotes + bibliography.
 - **Author-Date:** Similar to APA.
- **Example:** Smith, John. *Title of Book*. Chicago: University Press, 2023.
- **IEEE (Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers)**
 - Common in: Engineering, computer science.
 - **In-text citation:** [Number]
 - **Example:** [1]
 - **Reference list:** [1] A. Author, "Title," *Journal Name*, vol. X, no. Y, pp. Z, Year.
- **Harvard**
 - Common in: Many disciplines.
 - **In-text citation:** (Author, Year)
 - **Example:** (Smith, 2023)
 - Similar to APA but with slight differences in formatting.
 - 💡 **Tip:** Always check your **journal or university guidelines** for the required style.



Reference Management

- **Reference management** refers to the process of **collecting, organizing, storing, and citing references (sources)** used in academic or research work.
- It ensures that all the books, journal articles, conference papers, and other sources you consult are properly documented and easily retrievable.



Why is it important?

- **Avoid plagiarism** by giving proper credit.
- **Save time** when writing papers (automatic citation generation).
- **Maintain consistency** in citation styles (APA, IEEE, etc.).
- **Organize research** for easy access and collaboration.



What do reference management tools do?

- Import references from databases (Google Scholar, Scopus, etc.).
- Store PDFs and metadata.
- Generate citations and bibliographies automatically.
- Sync across devices and enable collaboration.
- Common tools: **Zotero**, **Mendeley**, **EndNote**.

Zotero

- **Pros:**

- Free and open-source.
- Excellent for organizing references and PDFs.
- Strong integration with Word, LibreOffice, and Google Docs.
- Great for collaborative work (group libraries).
- Works well with SLR tools like **Rayyan** (via RIS export).

- **Cons:**

- Limited built-in PDF annotation (though improving).
- Cloud storage is limited (300 MB free).

Mendeley

- **Pros:**

- Good PDF annotation and note-taking features.
- Strong integration with Word.
- Social networking features for researchers.

- **Cons:**

- Owned by Elsevier (some researchers avoid it for ethical reasons).
- Free storage is limited (2 GB).
- Some advanced features now require a paid plan.



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My Library

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Virginia Woolf's Little-Known Biography of a Cocker Spaniel	Schwartz	2018	
Aisles of Dogs	Prato and Kehrt	2018	
Thomas Hardy and Animals by Anna West, and: Victorian Dogs, Victorian M...	McDonell	2018	
Representing animals in the literature of Victorian Britain	McDonell	2018	
The Trouble with Dogs for a Writer	Knausgaard	2018	
Victorian Dogs, Victorian Men: Affect and Animals in Nineteenth-Century Li...	Klaver	2018	
Well, <i>Has</i> a Single Good Author Ever Owned a Dog?	Hovanec	2018	
Good Boy: Canine Representation in Cinema	Chodosh	2018	
I Tried to Make My Dog an Instagram Celebrity. I Failed.	Chen	2018	

The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movies on breed registrations in the United States

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Abstract The media is a powerful forc...

1 Attachment

PLOS ONE

RESEARCH ARTICLE

The making of a (dog) movie star: The effect of the portrayal of dogs in movies on breed registrations in the United States

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Abstract

The media is a powerful force that can affect the welfare of the domesticated dog population. Dogs have long been in human stories and their depictions can create demand for the breeds shown. While previous research has found that this effect can last for up to ten years after the release of a movie, how this phenomenon occurs is unknown. This paper examines if how a dog is portrayed in a movie is associated with a subsequent change in American Kennel Club breed registrations for that breed. Following a systematic literature review, four key themes were identified in how dogs are portrayed in the media: dogs portrayed as heroes, as anthropomorphised, as embodying the ideas of Western societies (Whiteness and heteronormativity) and as boundaries between wilderness and human society. Forty movies from between 1930 to 2004 were analysed, resulting in 95 dog characters scored, and hierarchical multiple linear regression was run. Movies with dogs portrayed as heroes were followed by significant increases in the number of American Kennel Club breed registrations for the breed shown, while anthropomorphised dogs were followed by significant decreases in the number of dogs registered for up to five years after a movie's release. These results indicate that how dogs are portrayed may be an important driver of demand for breeds. Future work should investigate whether these portrayals may have negative welfare implications for real dogs by leading to owners having unrealistic expectations for dogs or increasing demand for dogs with in-breeding related disorders.

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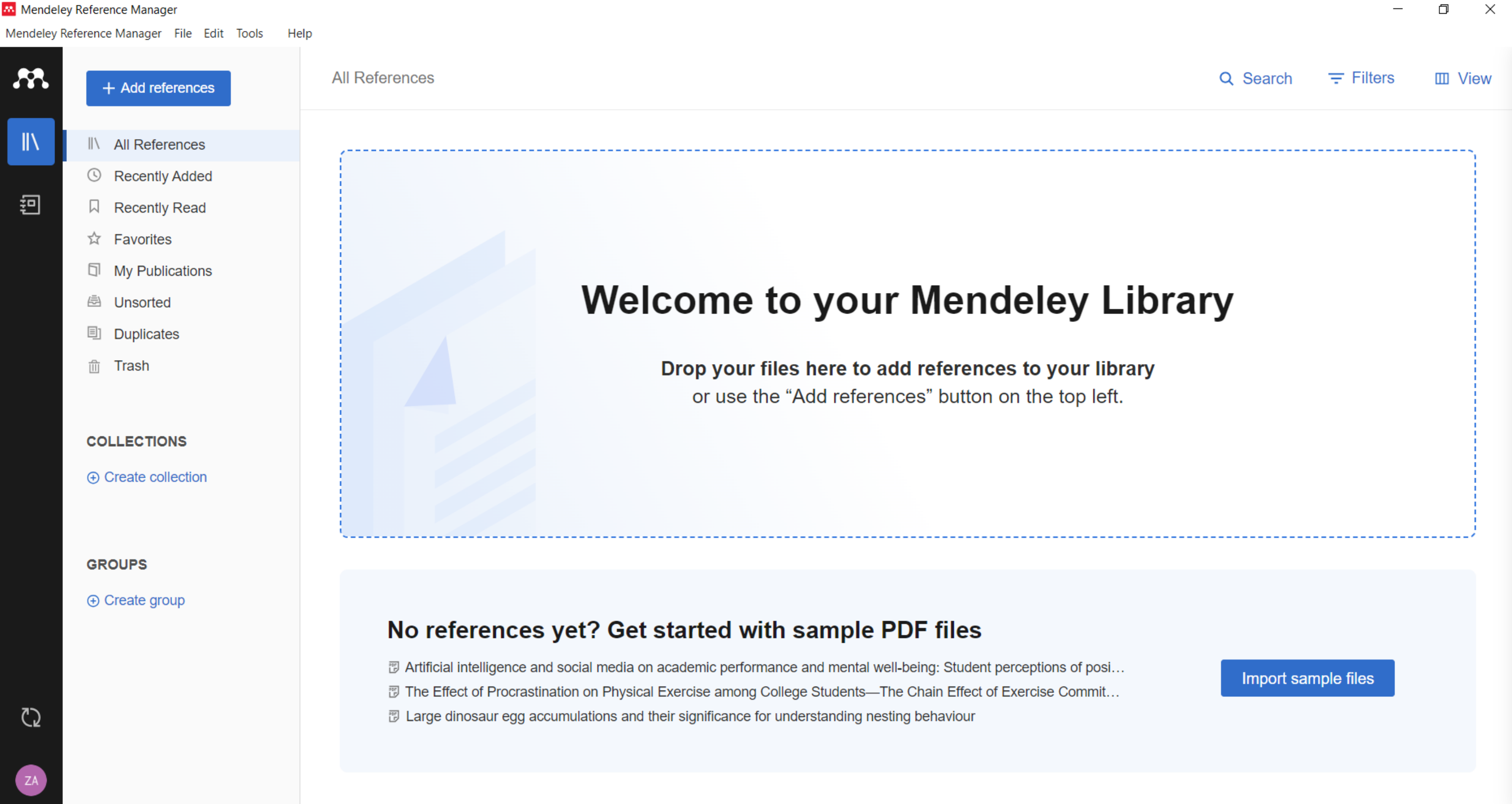
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Mendeley by Elsevier



Visualization



Why Visualization Matters

- Makes complex ideas easier to understand.
- Summarizes large amounts of data or concepts clearly.
- Improves reader engagement and comprehension.
- Essential for explaining **proposed methods**, **taxonomies**, and **SLR workflows**.

Common Types of Visualizations

- **Types of Figures in Research Papers**
- **Flowcharts** – Show processes or methods.
- **Taxonomy Diagrams** – Hierarchical classification.
- **Graphs & Charts** – Bar, line, scatter, pie for data.
- **Conceptual Models** – Show relationships between components.
- **PRISMA Diagrams** – For SLR article selection.
- **Tables** – Summarize data or comparisons.
- **Images/Illustrations** – Microscopy, architecture, etc.

Best Practices

- **Clarity over complexity** – Avoid clutter.
- **Consistency** – Use uniform colors, fonts, and shapes.
- **Label everything** – Titles, legends, and captions are essential.
- **Relevance** – Every figure should add value to the paper.
- **Follow journal guidelines** – Size, resolution, and format requirements.



Popular Visualization Tools

For Research Papers

- **Microsoft PowerPoint / Word** – Basic diagrams
- **Microsoft Visio** - Advance Level
- **LaTeX (TikZ, PGFPlots)** – Professional academic diagrams
- **Draw.io / Diagrams.net** – Free online diagramming
- **Lucidchart** – Collaborative flowcharts

- **MindMeister / XMind** – Mind maps and taxonomies

For Data Visualization

- **Tableau** – Interactive dashboards
- **Power BI** – Business and research analytics
- **Python (Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly)** – Advanced data visualization
- **R (ggplot2)** – Statistical graphics



Figure Quality

- **Resolution:** Minimum 300 dpi for print; 600 dpi for line art.
- **File Formats:**
 - **Preferred:** TIFF, EPS, PDF (for journals)
 - **Acceptable:** PNG, JPEG (for web or drafts)
- **Size:** Follow journal guidelines (avoid pixelation).
- **Color Mode:**
 - **RGB** for online
 - **CMYK** for print
- **Clarity:** No blurry text, consistent fonts, readable labels.
- **Accessibility:** Use colorblind-friendly palettes.



Figure and Tables

- 💡 **Tip:** Always include **figure captions** and **numbering** (e.g., Figure 1: Proposed Method Flowchart).
- **Figure Captions**
- Every figure must have a **caption** that clearly describes what it shows.
- Captions usually go **below the figure**.
- Example:
Figure 1: Proposed Method Flowchart
- **Table Captions**
- Tables also need captions, but these go **above the table**.
- Example:
Table 1: Summary of Reviewed Studies
- **Numbering**
- Figures and tables are numbered **separately** in the order they appear.
- Use consistent formatting throughout the paper.
- 💡 **Tip for Students:**
- Always refer to figures and tables in the text (e.g., “*As shown in Figure 2...*”).
- Follow the **journal’s style guide** (APA, IEEE, etc.) for exact formatting.

Hands-On Demo

- Create a **flowchart** for a proposed method using Draw.io
- Generate a **taxonomy diagram** in PowerPoint
- Plot a **graph** using Python (Matplotlib)